

Mouse Basics

This chapter is for IIGS users who have limited experience with the IIGS mouse. Although such a chapter may seem unnecessary—most everyone has used a mouse at one time or another—this chapter also ensures we’re all talking about the same thing when we talk about mouse actions.

The mouse is a simple, elegant device for moving the pointer around on the IIGS screen. On the bottom of the mouse is a small rubber ball, which rolls as you move the mouse around your desktop. Sensors inside the mouse track the rotation of the ball, and, like magic, the on-screen pointer follows your hand movement.

The mouse only detects movement when it is on a smooth, flat surface. If you run out of desk space before you reach the spot you’re aiming for on the screen, you can just pick up the mouse and move it back. Since the ball isn’t touching the desk, the mouse doesn’t register the movement, and you now have more room to move in the direction you want to go. (Experienced mousers pick up the front end of the mouse just enough to move it without the ball touching the desk.)

The mouse also has a long tail-like cord connecting it to the computer, and a button on the top. (If the cord is the mouse’s tail, the button is positioned atop, well, its hind end.) This button is used to select documents, icons, and menus. You may have seen mice on other computers with two or three buttons—but you do can everything with a single button on the Apple Desktop.

If you’re just getting started with the mouse, you may want to start up the System Disk to get to the Finder and follow along.

Pointing

The simplest mouse action is pointing. To point to something on the screen, just move the pointer to it. Position the pointer on top of the object you wish to point to—not above it, but literally on top of it (Figure 4A), as if you were looking down on the desktop from above and the pointer was on top of the object. (In Figure 4A, we’re pointing to the System Disk. Look closely at the System Disk icon to find the pointer.)